

SIGNATURE TALENT

Walter Ng, Spread Maximizer

EXECUTIVE

HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires an Annuity funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 2 of your loss from its Longevity or Low Interest Rates clauses.

At the start of your turn, look at the top card of your deck. You may put it on the bottom.

Can quote the spread between the portfolio yield and the crediting rate to four decimals, at dinner.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 202 / 379

OFFICE LOCATION

Zurich

OFFICE LOCATION

OPEN

◆ 4

branch only

Headquarters or **Open** as a branch.

Commit this office during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity, Credit, or Low Interest Rates clauses.

The flag is a big plus!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 357 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Traditional Variable Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1

run start

▲ Long-Term Equity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Volatility

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers invest in the market; you guarantee they can't lose. What could go wrong?

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 007 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Traditional Variable Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1

run start

▲ Long-Term Equity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Volatility

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers invest in the market; you guarantee they can't lose. What could go wrong?

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 007 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Traditional Variable Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1

run start

▲ Long-Term Equity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Volatility

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers invest in the market; you guarantee they can't lose. What could go wrong?

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 007 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1

run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 009 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 009 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 009 / 379

STABLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 379

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Longevity Income Rider

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Regulation

▼ Mortality

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A promise to keep paying, even when customers insist on living forever.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 011 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Longevity Income Rider

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Regulation

▼ Mortality

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A promise to keep paying, even when customers insist on living forever.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 011 / 379

FUNDING SOURCE

Buffered Index Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Short-Term Equity

▲ Long-Term Equity

▲ Volatility

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers get upside, you get basis risk, and everyone gets a brochure.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 012 / 379

INVESTMENT

INVESTMENT

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT



COST ♦ 2	YIELD ● 1 each turn	SALE 1 any time
-------------	------------------------	--------------------

▲ Rising Interest Rates ▼ Short-Term Equity

Yield +1 while your company has no unhedged Rising Interest Rates exposure.
Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 053 / 379

INVESTMENT

INVESTMENT

Mortgage-Backed Securities

INVESTMENT



COST ♦ 3	YIELD ● 2 each turn	SALE 2 any time
-------------	------------------------	--------------------

▲ Property Value ▲ Rising Interest Rates
▼ Low Interest Rates

Destroyed if Great Recession or U.S. Housing Crash hits you.

No longer the most volatile MBS.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 058 / 379

INVESTMENT

INVESTMENT

Mortgage-Backed Securities

INVESTMENT



COST ♦ 3	YIELD ● 2 each turn	SALE 2 any time
-------------	------------------------	--------------------

▲ Property Value ▲ Rising Interest Rates
▼ Low Interest Rates

Destroyed if Great Recession or U.S. Housing Crash hits you.

No longer the most volatile MBS.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 058 / 379

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Dynamic Hedging Program

TREATY



COST ♦ 3	CARRYING COST ● 1 each turn
-------------	--------------------------------

SIGNATURE
Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires an Annuity or Financials funding source.
Halve your loss from Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, and Volatility clauses (round down).

The hedge works perfectly, except when the market moves.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 118 / 379

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Longevity Swap

TREATY



COST ♦ 2

Requires an Annuity funding source.
Halve your loss from Longevity clauses (round down).

Your retirees can live as long as they like, now that someone else is paying for the extra years.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 117 / 379

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Longevity Swap

TREATY



COST ♦ 2

Requires an Annuity funding source.
Halve your loss from Longevity clauses (round down).

Your retirees can live as long as they like, now that someone else is paying for the extra years.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 117 / 379

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Protective Put

COVER



COST ♦ 2

COVER
Cover: discard it if that card leaves play.

Attach to one of your investments. Its exposures don't count.

A floor under one position, paid for up front.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 135 / 379

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Protective Put

COVER



COST ♦ 2

COVER
Cover: discard it if that card leaves play.

Attach to one of your investments. Its exposures don't count.

A floor under one position, paid for up front.

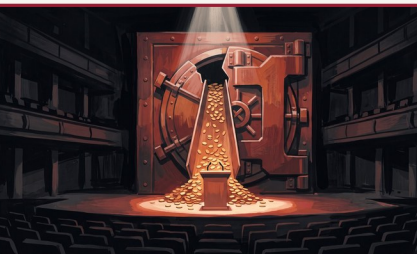
ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 135 / 379

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Reserve Release

RESPONSE



COST ♦ 1

DARK RESPONSE

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Gain 3 Surplus.

This quarter's earnings agree that last year's reserves were too cautious.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 143 / 379

ALM Director

RISK & COMPLIANCE

TALENT



HIRE

◆4

Requires an Annuity funding source.
Halve your loss from Low Interest Rates clauses (round down).
Matches every liability to an asset and every asset to a spreadsheet tab.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 180 / 379

Hedge Desk Trader

RISK & COMPLIANCE

TALENT



HIRE

◆3

Requires an Annuity or Financials funding source.
Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, or Volatility clauses.
Rebalances the hedge at 3 a.m. so the guarantee still works at 9.

A

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 181 / 379

Chief Investment Officer

EXECUTIVE

TALENT



HIRE

◆4

Requires an Annuity funding source.
At the start of your turn, if you control an investment, gain 1 more Surplus.
Believes every problem can be solved with another two basis points of yield.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 183 / 379

Cook the Books

RESPONSE

RISK MANAGEMENT



COST

◆1

DARK

RESPONSE

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.
The numbers were fine once they had a little help getting there.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 142 / 379

Nuclear Verdict

LITIGATION

SURPRISE INSPECTION



COST

◆4

HITS

Target opponent

Litigation

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Litigation exposure and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 2 more.
The jury took forty minutes to reach a verdict that will take four years to appeal.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 274 / 379

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY

SURPRISE INSPECTION



COST

◆4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

Liquidity

Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.
The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 279 / 379

Whistleblower

CORPORATE

SURPRISE INSPECTION



COST

◆3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.
After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.
She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.

A

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 301 / 379

Funding Agreement Notes

ANNUITY · FINANCIALS

SIGNATURE FUNDING SOURCE



CAPACITY

◆1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

●0

run start

SIGNATURE

Rising Interest Rates

Liquidity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Sold like a bond, rated like a policy, spent like a lending fund.

A

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 043 / 379

Feeder Fund

ILLIQUID

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT



COST

◆3

YIELD

●2

each turn

SIGNATURE

ILLIQUID

Signature: one copy per deck; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Whistleblower, Congressional Hearing, Northern Rock Bank Run, or Madoff Unmasked hits you.
Up about one percent a month for years, in every market, and nobody wanted to be rude and ask how.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 083 / 379

Des Moines

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 3 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 4 Life or Annuity funding sources you control, rounded down.

At the start of your turn, if you control a Life or Annuity funding source and a Private Credit Fund, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies).

Long lives, long loans, and a very short commute.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 360 / 379

LDI Overlay

TREATY



COST

◆ 0

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Low Interest Rates exposures counts as Liquidity instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier Risk Management cards choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

Matched for thirty years, with the cash due by four o'clock.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 161 / 379

Long Straddle

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

SALE

1 any time

CARRYING COST

◆ 1 each turn

Short-Term Equity

When a Stress Test with a Volatility clause hits you, gain 10% of the Surplus the whole table loses after protection and recoveries. Add your long-vol payouts, then round down.

Pays whichever way the market breaks, as long as it breaks before the premium runs out.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 098 / 379

Reinsurer Insolvency

MARKET



COST

◆ 1

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one Risk Management card to discard, chosen by the runner.

The treaty was airtight. The reinsurer was not.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 338 / 379

Noncompete Injunction

LITIGATION



COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

The judge agreed that the agreement was enforceable, and that the new job started in eighteen months.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 340 / 379

Early Warning System

DATA



PRICE

◆ 2

Cyber

Commit this tool to look at the top card of the Stress Test pile. Only you see it.

Forty dashboards, one blinking light, and an intern assigned to watch it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 379 / 379

1918 Influenza

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 1918



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Mortality

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

The 1918 influenza pandemic swept the world in three waves and killed tens of millions of people, many of them young adults.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 244 / 379

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Mortality

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 237 / 379

Hurricane Andrew

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 1992



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Nat Cat: Flood

▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Nat Cat: Flood exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

In August 1992, Hurricane Andrew came ashore south of Miami with winds above 160 mph and destroyed or damaged more than 100,000 homes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 240 / 379

Affordable Care Act

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In March 2010, the Affordable Care Act became law and rewrote the rules of American health insurance. Every four years, half the actuaries update their assumptions and the other half update their resumes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 253 / 379

Debt Ceiling Breach

MARKET



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Liquidity
▲ Rising Interest Rates ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Rising Interest Rates exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Long-Term Treasuries it controls.

Everyone knew the date, which Congress treated as a suggestion.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 271 / 379

IFRS 17

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2023



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 1 Surplus per Dark card on its board. Then each company discards its hand and draws that many cards.

On January 1, 2023, IFRS 17, the first full international accounting standard for insurance contracts, took effect. Effective for fiscal years beginning after the one you planned for.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 297 / 379

Dash for Cash

LIQUIDITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Credit ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 3 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 3 per Short-Term Equity exposure, 3 per Credit exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

In March 2020, investors sold almost everything, even U.S. Treasuries, to raise cash, until the Federal Reserve stepped in.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 273 / 379

Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

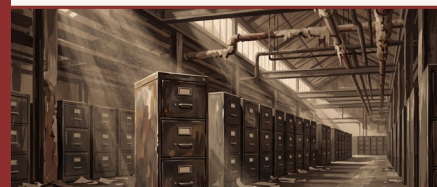
Talk about a viral tweet!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 245 / 379

Asbestos Claims

LITIGATION



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped; Developing Event: all stages this round, each with a response window.

Stage 1. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 2. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 3. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

The exposure was decades old, and the claims kept coming for decades more.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 295 / 379

Vietnam War

GEOPOLITICAL · AS-IF REPLAY, 1965



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Inflation ▲ Mortality

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Inflation exposure and 4 per Mortality exposure.

In 1965 the United States sent combat troops to Vietnam, starting a long war that cost millions of lives and helped push up inflation at home.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 266 / 379

Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

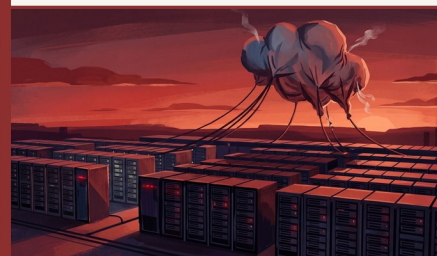
On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 290 / 379

AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.

On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 288 / 379

Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.

On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 343 / 379

Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.

In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 260 / 379

Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.

In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 309 / 379

Great Bond Massacre

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1994



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Rising Interest Rates exposure and 3 per Volatility exposure.

On February 4, 1994, the Federal Reserve raised rates by surprise and kept raising them all year, and bond prices fell around the world. Orange County found out in December.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 306 / 379